

Human Rights Commission August 18th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BsnJpCQfzeU
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Municipal Meeting Summary: Muncie Fire Merit Commission

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Not applicable. No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular monthly meeting of the Muncie Fire Merit Commission was called to order at **00:00:28** by the presiding officer at 6:00 PM.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Sam, Mike, Chief Berford, Mark, and Michael (Commissioners / Board Members explicitly noted during roll call).
 - **Members Absent:** Not specified in the transcript.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified through meeting direction (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not explicitly noted in the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:01:01 The minutes of the July 10th meeting were presented, motioned, seconded, and approved by voice vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:02:49 Promotion to Sergeant: Trey McCauley

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fire Chief.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Following the official resignation of a 9-year veteran firefighter and sergeant (Sergeant Duggar), the Chief requested a promotion to fill the vacant sergeant's position. The top three candidates on the updated eligibility list were read aloud: 1) Trey Macaulay, 2) Janae Jackson (noted as recently married and now named Jana Fields), and 3) Cullen Tafflinger. The Chief respectfully requested the appointment of Trey McCauley.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote. (Candidate Trey McCauley was pinned and congratulated during the meeting).

00:07:55 Proposed Amendments to Rule and Procedure Number Eight

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner White.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioner White briefed the commission on the proposed amendments to Rule and Procedure Number Eight, which pertains to the promotional process and evaluation scores. The changes aim to address long-standing concerns from Muncie firefighters regarding fairness and potential opinion-based manipulation in evaluations. Feedback from department members was gathered over several months and incorporated into the final text.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - 00:09:58 **Jason Chaffin:** Expressed gratitude to Mike, Linda, and everyone involved for their work on resolving long-standing issues with promotional evaluation forms.
 - 00:10:28 **Battalian Chief Sykes (First Battalion):** Thanked the commission for looking into the matter and acting as a strong voice for the fire department to make the process fairer.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously via Roll Call Vote.
 - *Roll Call Tally:* Clemens (Yes), Andrew Dale (Yes), Mike (Yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General floor comments or remarks from department leadership/personnel during the meeting discussions)

- **00:11:51 Unidentified Speaker / Officer:** Requested that the commission begin looking ahead and coordinating dates (including consulting IPS and allowing for the required 90-day study period) for upcoming promotions. Also requested clean, finalized PDF copies of all merit rules (Rules 1 through 11) distributed to the membership in a single file.
- **00:13:14 Battalion Chief:** Echoed the request regarding consolidating all rules into a single PDF document for easy reference by the membership.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Recruit & Staffing Updates:** Recruits are progressing well. One recruit (Bennett Whitel) finishes the academy early due to prior EMT certification and starts on shift Monday with the Third Battalion. A recent sergeant resignation occurred, and the department is evaluating the timing for a conditional offer. The city has applied for a SAFER grant for manpower, though no announcement has been made yet.
 - **Station Construction:** Construction on the new fire station is proceeding well with strong daily crew attendance, drywall finishing, plumbing, electrical, and overhead doors in place; masonry is set to finish next week with a target move-in date before Christmas.
 - **Disciplinary Matter:** Attorney Mark Irvin reported that Disciplinary Matter 25-1, previously scheduled for a hearing on the 18th, has been postponed by court order until further notice.
- **Adjournment:** **00:14:07** A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and approved by voice vote.

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